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Human Brain map

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Mid-Tower Cabinets

tage of the cabinet's depth of accommodating those beefy graphics cards measuring up to 480mm. The drive bays are suited more towards HDDs by attaching clips to hold them on which you can install SSDs as well. There aren't any dedicated SSD caddies inside but they've taken a smart approach of giving you the option to vertically mount the bays behind the motherboard plate. This approach is better if you're planning to install SSDs, only on the top slot, and also want to get rid of the drive bay at the front. But the installation of SSDs could have been better since it's difficult with the clips. Removing the drive bays also gives more options to install up to either two 120mm fans or a 240mm radiator at the bottom, rarely seen in cabinets. So, when it comes to cooling, Thermaltake has you covered completely.

Apart from all the good things about the cabinet, the case lacks proper cable man-

agement. It does include the regular and expected cutouts on the motherboard plate for main power, CPU power, GPU power and SATA interfaces, but the space provided behind isn't enough. To have a neat-looking cable arrangement, you will have to spend enough time rerouting the cables. Of course, the job becomes easier if you have sleeved cables in your PSU, but it's tedious with rounded cables and a pain with non-modular PSUs. Although, cable management took some time (mostly included us trying to adjust the cables to close the side panel), the assembly process was the quickest in this cabinet.

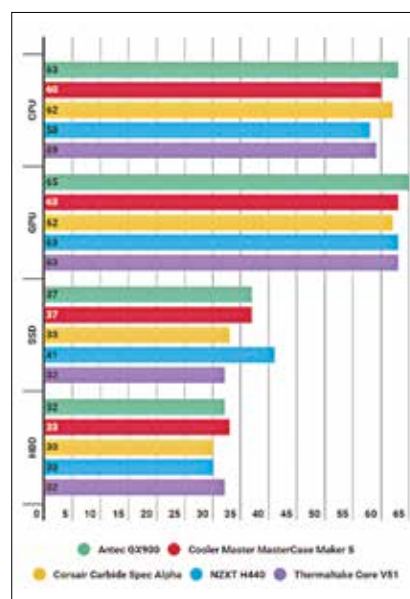
VERDICT

The temperature levels inside a cabinet are dependent on a lot of factors, and the Thermaltake Core V51 has won the Best Performer award in this test. The score differences weren't phenomenally high since there are a couple

of factors why the Core V51 won marginally. In our storage stress test, we observed SSDs installed over the PSU shroud to run really hot. This wasn't the case for the ones installed in the drive bays placed near the front panel right behind the front intake fans. This is where the cabinet had an advantage while the open meshed front panel also gave unhindered air intake.

The Antec GX900 sweeps away the Best Buy award easily considering its cheap price while covering the bare-bones features from radiator support to supporting a graphics card with a maximum length of 310mm. Yes, it doesn't include the level of modularity observed on the other cabinets, nor does it include the expansive support for cooling solutions, but this absence is compensated by its low price. Hence, on a budget, this comes out as the best pick. Now, one could argue there are better options from other manufacturers in the same price segment, but it should also be considered that the recommendation is restricted to the products covered in this mini-comparison test.

Coming to the Editor's Pick, it definitely has to be the Cooler Master MasterCase Maker 5. If you individually look at the scores obtained under features and build quality, the Maker 5 has the highest scores in both. And once you start tinkering with



Load temperatures (in °C)

the cabinet, you'll realise that each and every part of it reflects top quality. Being the most generous with compartments, tie slits, grooves and accessories for cable management, we had fun assembling our testing rig inside the cabinet. It has the highest level of modularity, no doubt about it. The only shortcoming here is the price, but since it's directed towards enthusiasts strictly, the price and the features offered are justified, apart from a few things we have already mentioned in our full review. As a regular user who only wants to assemble a basic gaming rig, you wouldn't actually need such a feature rich cabinet unless you're an enthusiast.

The idea behind this mini-comparison test was to determine the best cabinet in the mid-tower category among the top-end model each, from cabinet manufacturers. The sample space here was small but we do plan on conducting more comparisons covering several cabinets and also various categories.



Thermaltake Core V51